

Religious Studies: Philosophy and Ethics

(A Level, AQA)

This course is the most popular route to Philosophy in the UK, and as such recognised for this at universities. It develops critical and analytical thinking through studying western Philosophy and Ethics. A thoughtful and inquiring approach is required, as well as being able to write in length using academic language. Lively discussions, seminar presentations, videos, and conferences all form part of the course, to enable you to extend your ideas and to become adept thinkers. Topics such as Religion and Science, Medical Ethics and Gender and Sexuality mean that no two years are ever the same as we adapt our ideas and principles to the constantly changing world.

Entry Requirements:

Grade 5 in GCSE Philosophy and Religion or Religious Studies and/or a grade 5 in English.

Course Content:

Unit	%	When?	Content
Paper 1: Philosophy and Religion and Ethics	50%	June of Year 13	Philosophy • Arguments for the existence of God; Can we prove God exists? • Evil and suffering • Religious experience • Religious language • Miracles • The Soul – do they exist and do they live on after death Christian Ethics: • Ethical Theories – Natural Moral Law, Situation Ethics, Virtue Ethics • Issue of human life and death • Issues of animal life and death • Introduction to meta ethics • Free will and moral responsibility • Conscience; Bentham and Kant.
Paper 2: Christianity and dialogues	50%	June of Year 13	Section A: Study of Religion • Sources of wisdom and authority • Gods/gods/ultimate responsibility • Self, death and the afterlife • Good conduct and key moral principles • Expression of religious identity • Religion gender and sexuality • Religion and science • Religion and secularisation • Religion and religious pluralism Section B: The dialogue between philosophy of religion and religion. How religion is influenced by, and has an influence on, philosophy of religion in relation to the issues studied. Section C: The dialogue between ethical studies and religion. How religion is influenced by, and has an influence on, ethical studies in relation to the issues studied.

Costs associated with this course:

If students would like their own revision guide for the course, we recommend the AQA Religious Studies Paper 1: Philosophy and Ethics and AQA Religious Studies Paper 2: Christianity and Dialogues.

Students do not need to buy a textbook, but they will need a ring binder for Philosophy, Ethics and Christianity (three in total) and their own lined paper.

Career Links

The subject is useful as a traditional academic subject, providing a secure foundation for any future direction. Students who have recently studied this course have gone to university to read a diverse range of degrees including Law, History, Mathematics and Philosophy, French and Philosophy, and Accounting. Some have continued their interest through Theology and Philosophy degrees. Others have gone into Nursing and Theatre Studies.

For more information please contact Mrs E Brae